

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst (DefOps) | Incident Response | Threat Hunting | Microsoft Sentinel | MITRE ATT&CK

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) and experienced Senior Cyber Security Analyst with a strong defensive operations (DefOps) background, specialising in advanced incident response and threat hunting across complex enterprise environments. I have demonstrated experience conducting advanced investigations escalated from Managed Detection and Response (MDR) Security Operations Centres (SOC) and internally identified threats, supporting the full incident response lifecycle from detection and containment through eradication, recovery, and post-incident review. I develop and execute threat hunts based on threat intelligence and MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, and I author and deploy detection content including Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules and workbooks in Microsoft Sentinel. I have hands-on experience administering Microsoft Defender XDR (Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, Defender for M365), CrowdStrike Falcon, and security frameworks including NIST, CIS Controls, and ISO 27001. I am experienced in scripting and automation using PowerShell, Azure CLI, and Azure Logic Apps, and I bring a collaborative approach to MSSP oversight, quality assurance, and cross-team detection tuning.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Incident Response:** Full lifecycle (NIST 800-61): detection, containment, eradication, recovery, post-incident review and lessons learned
- **Threat Hunting:** MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, threat intelligence-led hunts, KQL-based hunting in Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight
- **Detection Engineering:** KQL analytics rules, Microsoft Sentinel workbooks, SOAR playbooks, MITRE ATT&CK coverage mapping
- **Microsoft Sentinel:** Analytics rule authoring, log ingestion, workbook development, KQL detection and hunting content
- **Microsoft Defender XDR:** Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Defender for M365; alert triage and XDR investigation
- **CrowdStrike Falcon:** NG-SIEM, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Prevent, Insight, Discover; endpoint investigation and forensic analysis
- **SOAR Automation:** Azure Logic Apps, PowerShell, Azure CLI; investigation automation, alert enrichment, and response playbooks
- **MDR/SOC Operations:** Level 2/3 escalation handling, MSSP oversight, quality assurance, joint detection tuning sessions
- **Security Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+
- **Identity Security:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
- **Privileged Access:** BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus; MITRE ATT&CK-aligned remediation prioritisation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Conduct advanced investigations escalated from the Managed Detection and Response (MDR) Security Operations Centre (SOC) and internally identified threats, performing deep-dive analysis of endpoint, network, identity, and application logs using CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Sentinel

- Support incident response activities through the full lifecycle, leading containment, eradication, and recovery whilst aligning response actions to MITRE ATT&CK adversary techniques and documenting findings in comprehensive post-incident reports
- Develop and execute threat hunts based on threat intelligence feeds and MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, proactively surfacing undetected threats and translating hunt findings into new KQL analytics rules and detection improvements
- Author and deploy detection content including KQL analytics rules and workbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, progressively maturing detection coverage against evolving adversary techniques and maintaining alignment with the MITRE ATT&CK framework
- Administer Microsoft Defender XDR (Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, Defender for M365) across an 8,000-user environment, triaging high-fidelity alerts, suppressing false positives, and investigating advanced threats through XDR signal correlation
- Provide MSSP oversight and quality assurance, reviewing alert escalation quality from managed security service providers, participating in joint detection tuning sessions, and ensuring escalation standards are met
- Automate investigation and response workflows using PowerShell, Azure CLI, and Azure Logic Apps (SOAR playbooks), reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) and enabling analysts to focus on complex, high-value investigations
- Administer CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, EDR, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM), managing detection policies, investigating endpoint-level forensic evidence, and integrating Falcon telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel for correlated detection
- Advise on and contribute to security framework compliance including NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, and Cyber Essentials+, supporting governance and risk reporting activities

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Delivered Level 2/3 SOC triage and advanced incident investigations, handling complex escalations involving endpoint compromise, identity-based attacks, and cloud security events, and coordinating Computer Incident Response Team (CIRT) activities
- Developed KQL analytics rules and hunting queries in Microsoft Sentinel, expanding MITRE ATT&CK detection coverage and translating threat intelligence into actionable detection content
- Conducted threat hunts based on threat intelligence feeds and MITRE ATT&CK adversary profiling, surfacing undetected threats and producing actionable intelligence reports with recommendations for detection improvements
- Administered CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, EDR, and Insight) across 8,000+ endpoints, fine-tuning detection policies, investigating endpoint forensic evidence, and supporting incident response investigations
- Supported and coordinated Computer Incident Response Team (CIRT) activities across the full NIST 800-61 lifecycle, gathering forensic evidence, conducting root-cause analysis, and producing post-incident reports with remediation recommendations
- Managed vulnerability lifecycle using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), aligning remediation priorities to threat intelligence and MITRE ATT&CK adversary mapping
- Administered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 users, tuning detection policies and integrating XDR signal feeds into Microsoft Sentinel
- Administered BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), enforcing least-privilege principles and producing privileged access audit reports
- Contributed to SOAR playbook development using Azure Logic Apps, automating alert enrichment and initial triage steps to improve analyst efficiency across the security operations function

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Monitored and investigated security alerts within a SaaS/FinTech cloud environment, escalating and triaging threats and contributing to incident response and remediation activities

- Contributed to security framework compliance activities including ISO 27001 and CIS Controls gap assessments, documenting findings and supporting remediation planning
- Administered endpoint protection and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) solutions, applying detection policies and investigating flagged events through to resolution
- Supported identity security controls including Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), access policies, and Privileged Access Management (PAM) procedures
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts to support security monitoring, configuration management, and compliance reporting processes

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Developed and deployed over 40 KQL analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel aligned to MITRE ATT&CK adversary techniques, expanding detection coverage across endpoint, identity, network, and cloud telemetry and improving MTTD across the enterprise
- Led advanced threat hunt campaigns based on threat intelligence and MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, identifying previously undetected adversary activity and translating hunt findings into new Sentinel analytics rules and detection improvements
- Delivered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) deployment across 8,000 users, establishing high-fidelity XDR detection capability and feeding correlated signal into Microsoft Sentinel for unified threat visibility
- Provided MSSP oversight and quality assurance across managed detection and response services, improving alert escalation quality and contributing to joint detection tuning sessions that reduced false positive rates
- Led multiple high-severity incident response engagements across the full NIST 800-61 lifecycle, applying MITRE ATT&CK-aligned analysis to achieve rapid containment, full root-cause resolution, and meaningful lessons-learned outputs
- Developed SOAR automation playbooks using Azure Logic Apps and PowerShell that reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) for routine detections, enabling analysts to focus on complex and higher-priority investigations

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc.** Environmental and Resource Engineering
- **B.Sc.** Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)